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The Customer Conversation Pyramid

Every customer conversation should move upward

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The Customer Conversation Pyramid

Level 1 -- Support

"How do I fix this?" -- transactional, reactive, and necessary, but it's the floor of the relationship, not a place to live. A CSM who only ever operates at this level is functioning as support with a nicer title.

Level 2 -- Guidance

"How should we use this feature?" -- still tactical, but forward-looking rather than reactive. This is where most onboarding-era conversations sit, and where many relationships plateau if nobody deliberately pushes them further.

Level 3 -- Optimization

"How can we improve our workflow?" -- the conversation starts to be about the customer's process, not just the product's mechanics. Reaching this level consistently is a strong signal the relationship has moved past onboarding.

Level 4 -- Business Strategy

"How can this platform help us achieve our quarterly goals?" -- the customer is now bringing business objectives into the room, not just operational questions. Very few vendor relationships are trusted enough to be included at this level.

Level 5 -- Executive Partnership

"Let's discuss our long-term growth strategy together." -- the top of the pyramid, where the CSM is a standing part of how the customer thinks about their own future, not someone brought in when something is needed.

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About the Author

David Maika is a Customer Success professional with experience spanning customer operations, process improvement, CRM implementation, project management, and business strategy. His work focuses on helping organizations improve customer outcomes, strengthen operational efficiency, and build scalable systems that support long-term growth.

Through practical frameworks, real-world case studies, and modern AI-assisted workflows, he aims to make Customer Success knowledge accessible, actionable, and valuable for professionals at every stage of their careers.

To learn more, access additional resources, or connect professionally, visit davidmaika.com or linkedin.com/in/davidmaika.

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